

Rise Together: Pathways for Newcomer Women

Program Modules & Sessions — Sahan Heritage Foundation, Calgary

Per cohort: 15 women · 12 weekly Saturdays · 60 contact hours. Mornings build job-readiness skills; afternoons build English and mentorship.

Morning sessions — Job Readiness (what each woman does, and why)

Module (the job)	Why it matters	Sessions	Women
Self-assessment & transferable skills	Surfaces skills she already has and builds the confidence to start a job search	2	15
Creating a resume	Produces a Canadian-style, ESL-adapted resume — the document needed to apply for any job	2	15
Cover letters & online applications	Teaches how jobs are actually applied for here: job boards, online forms, cover letters	2	15
Interview preparation & mock interviews	Practice and feedback reduce anxiety and turn applications into offers	2	15
Workplace communication	Phone, professional email, and workplace norms so she can start and keep a job	2	15
Networking & next-steps plan	Builds contacts, matches a mentor, and sets her action plan after the program	2	15

Afternoon sessions — English & Mentorship (every week)

Activity	Why it matters	Sessions	Women
Conversational / workplace English	Builds the practical English each week's job topic requires	12	15
Mentor circles	Small-group guidance and role models who have walked the same path	12	3–4 per mentor

Added supports & milestones

Activity	Why it matters	Sessions	Women
1:1 employment coaching	Individual help tailoring each resume and preparing for real interviews	Ongoing	Individual
Digital literacy (laptops)	Hands-on practice with online applications and email, often for the first time	Woven in	15 (shared)
Bridges cross-community	Builds social inclusion	1	15 + 5–8 guests

event	and anti-racism; expands her network beyond her community		
Graduation (Week 12)	Recognizes completion and reinforces community and momentum	1	15 + families

On-site childcare (runs all day, every session)

Activity	Why it matters	Sessions	Children
Registered childcare	Removes the #1 barrier — without it, single mothers cannot attend	12	15–25